



TACTIVISION.AI

OPPOSITION ANALYSIS · PFSA-STYLE INTELLIGENCE REPORT

OPPONENT ANALYSIS

FRANCE

4-2-3-1 in possession, shifting to a compact 4-4-2 out of possession

Competition:	FIFA World Cup 2026
Data source:	FIFA Post-Match Summary Reports (Phases of Play)
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PREPARED BY

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Headline tactical intelligence at a glance

TEAM IDENTITY

- Transition-oriented side with elite individual quality in wide areas.
- Comfortable ceding possession to strike on the counter.
- Direct vertical progression through the half-spaces.

MAIN STRENGTHS

- + Devastating attacking transitions
- + Individual match-winners in wide zones
- + Defensive compactness in a mid-block

MAIN WEAKNESSES

- Can be passive in sustained build-up
- Full-backs leave space when advanced
- Reliant on moments of individual quality

TACTICAL RISK

High threat of counter-attack — the primary route to being hurt.

OVERALL RECOMMENDATION

Control tempo in settled possession and protect against transition; deny the space in behind the defensive line.

TEAM IDENTITY & TACTICAL PROFILE

Playing identity and headline profile

- Transition-oriented side with elite individual quality in wide areas.
- Comfortable ceding possession to strike on the counter.
- Direct vertical progression through the half-spaces.

ANALYTICAL PROFILE

- Attacking threat — Consistently manufactures strong scoring opportunities; a clear attacking threat.
- Pressing intensity — Applies a balanced, controlled press with selective high engagement.
- Progression / territory — Progresses the ball into high-value zones with dangerous regularity.
- Defensive block — Holds a balanced mid-block, screening central lanes while staying compact.

FORMATION & STRUCTURAL BEHAVIOUR

Shape and positional structure

PREFERRED FORMATION

4-2-3-1 in possession, shifting to a compact 4-4-2 out of possession

STRUCTURAL BEHAVIOUR

Double pivot anchors central areas while the front four rotates fluidly; defensively the block folds into two banks of four with narrow spacing.

IN-POSSESSION ANALYSIS

Phases of play — with the ball

- Unopposed build-up: the side constructs play from the back unpressured as a defining feature of their game.
- Opposed build-up: the side plays out under pressure at times.
- Progression: the side moves the ball through the thirds in controlled phases regularly.
- Final third: the side sustains attacks in the final third at times.
- Long ball: the side resorts to direct long play only occasionally.
- Attacking transition: the side attacks on the transition regularly.
- Counter attack: the side launches outright counter-attacks only occasionally.
- Set piece: the side generates phases from set plays only occasionally.

OUT-OF-POSSESSION ANALYSIS

Phases of play — without the ball

- High press: the side presses high up the pitch only occasionally.
- Mid press: the side engages the press in midfield only occasionally.
- Low press: the side presses from a deep starting point almost never.
- High block: the side defends from a high block only occasionally.
- Mid block: the side defends from a mid-block regularly.
- Low block: the side drops into a low block regularly.
- Recovery: the side is recovering shape after being stretched only occasionally.
- Defensive transition: the side is exposed in defensive transition regularly.
- Counter-press: the side counter-presses on loss of the ball at times.

TRANSITIONS

Attacking & defensive transition behaviour

ATTACKING TRANSITION

Breaks at speed the instant possession is regained, hunting the channel between full-back and centre-back within the first few seconds.

DEFENSIVE TRANSITION

Retreats quickly into a mid-block rather than counter-pressing intensely; occasional disorganisation immediately after losing the ball high.

SET-PIECE PROFILE

Dead-ball tendencies

A measured but genuine set-piece threat, favouring near-post movement and second-phase deliveries.

KEY PLAYERS & THREAT MATRIX

Individuals to neutralise

Player	Role	Strength	Weakness	Instruction
Kylian Mbappé	Left forward / transition spearhead	Elite pace in behind	Limited defensive tracking	Deny the space behind the last line; screen the diagonal service to him.
Aurélien Tchouaméni	Deep pivot	Screens and recycles	Can be pinned when isolated	Occupy him with a runner from midfield to slow the first counter pass.
Antoine Griezmann	Connector / free 8	Links phases and finds pockets	Drifts out of defensive shape	Cut the central supply line to him early.

STRENGTHS & WEAKNESSES

Consolidated SWOT assessment

STRENGTHS

- + Devastating attacking transitions
- + Individual match-winners in wide zones
- + Defensive compactness in a mid-block

WEAKNESSES

- Can be passive in sustained build-up
- Full-backs leave space when advanced
- Reliant on moments of individual quality

MATCH PLAN RECOMMENDATIONS

How to exploit and how to contain

IN POSSESSION — HOW TO EXPLOIT

- Circulate patiently to draw the block narrow, then switch to isolate their advanced full-back.
- Commit runners beyond the striker to pin the double pivot.

OUT OF POSSESSION — HOW TO DEFEND

- Set a rest-defence to nullify the first transition pass.
- Shadow the connector to sever central links.

PRESSING TRIGGERS

- Backward passes toward the goalkeeper.
- Loose first touch in the opposed build-up phase.

RISK ZONES & VULNERABILITIES

Where we are most likely to be hurt

DANGER ZONES

- ! Space in behind the defensive line.
- ! The wide channel vacated by their attacking full-back.

OUR RISK ZONES

- ! Transition moments after our own attacks break down.
- ! Isolated 1v1 duels against their wide forwards.

PRE-MATCH TACTICAL PLAN

Phased game-management script

0-15 MINUTES — ESTABLISH CONTROL

Establish territorial control and set a disciplined rest-defence from kick-off.

MID-GAME — BUILD & DEFEND

Rotate the ball to stretch their mid-block and force them to defend for long spells.

70+ MINUTES — GAME MANAGEMENT

Guard against fresh pace introduced from the bench in the closing stages.

POST-MATCH ANALYTICAL REVIEW

Review framework for after the fixture

Review the number and quality of transitions conceded and the discipline of the rest-defence against direct vertical runs.